



Course Name

NIGERIAN PEOPLE'S & CULTURE

Topic: Nigerian People's & Culture

WEEK 6

IN SUMMARY

This week, you learned about Nigeria's indigenous trade system, which thrived between 1500 and 1800 AD. The indigenous economies of Nigeria were shaped by geographical factors, with varying regions specializing in different activities like agriculture, trade, and craftsmanship. Communities engaged in trade to exchange goods they produced for those they needed, forming a web of economic connections. The Niger River played a pivotal role in trade growth, and international markets attracted traders from various regions. However, the colonial intrusion disrupted this traditional system, transforming Nigeria's precolonial economy into the Western capitalist economic model.

Additionally, you explored Nigeria's modern economic realities. Nigeria's economy heavily relies on oil, which led to an overdependence on a single revenue source. Corruption, mismanagement, and a lack of economic diversification have exacerbated the country's economic challenges. The study also highlighted potential solutions, including economic diversification, infrastructure improvement, anti-corruption efforts, and reducing the cost of governance.

BULLET POINT SUMMARY

- The lesson explores Nigeria's precolonial indigenous trade system, emphasising the role of geography and natural resources in shaping economic activities.
- It highlights how economic specialization and the need for trade were influenced by geographical factors, leading to inter-group exchanges and cultural diffusion.
- The apprenticeship system in Nigeria is discussed, illustrating how it played a vital role in passing down skills and knowledge.
- The disruptive impact of colonialism on these traditional economic systems is acknowledged, altering social and political structures.
- The lesson transitions to Nigeria's modern economic realities, focusing on the country's over-reliance on crude oil, corruption, and the need for diversification.
- It emphasises the importance of addressing these contemporary economic challenges and investing in areas like renewable energy and human capital



CASE STUDY

QUESTIONS TO PONDER

Title: The Evolution of Trade in Nigeria: From Indigenous Systems to Modern Economic Realities

Introduction: This case study delves into the transition of trade in Nigeria from its indigenous systems to modern economic realities. It explores historical trade practises and their influence on the modern Nigerian economy, highlighting the challenges and potential solutions faced by the nation in diversifying and sustaining a robust economic landscape.

Objective: To trace the historical roots of Nigeria's trade systems and their impact on the modern economy. To examine the consequences of overdependence on oil and the role of corruption in the country's economic challenges. To analyse the suggested solutions for improving Nigeria's economic outlook, including diversification, infrastructure development, and anti-corruption measures.

Methods: This case study utilises historical research, economic analysis, and policy evaluation. It draws on historical records, academic literature, and economic data to trace the evolution of trade in Nigeria. The consequences of oil dependence, corruption, and mismanagement are analysed using economic metrics. Additionally, potential solutions for a more robust modern Nigerian economy are explored, focusing on diversification and governance reforms.

- Imagine the challenges faced by communities that were not self-sufficient and relied on trade for essential goods. What were the potential risks?
- How did the indigenous trade system contribute to cultural exchange and collaboration among Nigerian peoples?
- Can you think of ways in which the traditional trade system has influenced the modern economic landscape of Nigeria?



SKILLS AND COMPETENCIES YOU HAVE ACQUIRED AFTER THIS LESSON

- Historical Understanding
- Economic Analysis
- Cultural Awareness
- Geography and Economics
- Trade and Commerce Knowledge
- Critical Thinking

PERSONAL REFLECTION

Nigeria's precolonial trade system was shaped by geography, natural resources, and culture. Trade played a crucial role in connecting communities and passing down skills and knowledge. Colonialism had a disruptive impact, but Nigeria continues to explore modern economic solutions.